PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDENT

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STAFF REPORT

Date: July 24 , 2025

To: Board of Education

CC:

From: Deborah Kafoury, Chief of Staff
Brandon Coonrod, Director of Transportation

Subject: TriMet Student Passes for the 2025-26 School Year

BACKGROUND

Since 2009, PPS has had an agreement with TriMet to provide student transit passes to the district's high school students in lieu of the traditional yellow bus service. Historically, PPS has carried a $2.9M contract with TriMet, of which the district has been responsible for $1.9M.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

Without this agreement, PPS would have to fund the entire $2.9 million to run the program or make the choice to eliminate it altogether or revert to yellow bus service, which would not only be more costly for the district, but would not offer the same level of flexibility as TriMet.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

The direct benefits of providing this service to students are immediate and long-term. The partnership with Tri-Met directly supports the first pillar of the PPS Climate Crisis Response Policy (CCRP): Reduce Environmental Impact and Costs. Specifically, this partnership advances Goal 1.4 to minimize greenhouse gas emissions from student and staff transportation. Further, a central goal of this policy is to promote racial equity and climate justice. Providing Tri-Met passes allows students who do not have regular access to their own vehicle or consistent transportation to have greater access to pursue educational and career opportunities that may be a barrier to access otherwise. Through supporting a culture of public transit, the PPS community can help to reduce single occupancy vehicles on the roadways, reducing air pollution from cars that disproportionately impacts our most vulnerable communities.

FISCAL IMPACT

The total cost of the TriMet Youth Pass program is $2.9 million annually, with PPS historically paying $1,987,333 and TriMet “in-kinding” the additional $966,666. PPS has a waiver with the Oregon Department of Education that allows the district to purchase transit passes rather than yellow bus services at a 70% district reimbursement.

PPS will pay TriMet an amount not to exceed $1,987,333 for its share of the Total Program Cost, which includes $54,000 for the initial purchase of 18,000 Hop cards.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Because this is an annual renewal, there has been no student outreach.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

The transit passes are valid from August 26, 2025 through June 21, 2026.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Staff recommends board approval of this IGA.

ATTACHMENTS

- Intergovernmental Agreement

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